Name:
ID:

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
E304B
Exploring English Grammar (II)
Main - All Branches
Makeup - KSA
MTA Exam
2025-2026 / Spring
Date: 15 April 2026
9:30 – 11:30

Section: _____

Number of Exam Pages: 12 (Including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

1. Allow approximately 10 minutes to read the instructions on this page and to read through t whole examination paper.

2. There are TWO parts to this MTA examination paper:

Part A (20 marks): There are FOUR practical questions. You are required to answer all FOU questions.

Part B (10 marks): There are TWO essay questions. You are required to answer only ONE.

3. Carefully follow the instructions in each part.

4. In your answer, make sure that you:

- Write the number of the question that you decide to answer.

- Cross out any rough notes you make that you do not wish to be marked/graded.

5. Review your answers carefully, paying attention to your grammar, spelling, and punctuation as well as to relevant textual elements (e.g., paragraphing, cohesion & coherence), as part of th mark for each question will be given to language accuracy and text organization

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PART A

Answer ALL FOUR Questions (20 marks)

Question 1:

The noun groups (NGs) below all involve one or more postmodifiers. Circle the head noun (HN) and underline the postmodifiers in each Noun Group. Then, **identify the form** of each postmodifier *as a prepositional group, a finite embedded clause, and/or a non-finite embedded clause*.

(5 marks; each circled HN and underlined postmodifier = 0.5 mark and each label = 0.5 mark)

1. a conference on recent developments in AI ethics

   _____

2. the professor who teaches computational linguistics at the university

   _____

3. an initiative aimed at reducing plastic waste on campus

   _____

4. a study on the effects of social media on mental health

   _____

5. the student who won the scholarship for academic excellence

   _____

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Question 2:

Each of the following clauses has different types of lexical cohesion indicated by the words/phrases in **bold**. Write the type of lexical cohesion for each as:

- **Repetition** (same word repeated)
- **Antonymy** (words with opposite meanings)
- **Synonymy** (words with similar meanings)
- **Meronymy** (part-whole relationship)
- **Co-meronymy** (two words that are parts of the same whole)
- **Hyponymy** (specific term related to a general category)
- **Co-hyponymy** (two or more words that fall under the same category)

(5 marks: 1 mark each)

1. The **researcher** carefully recorded the results, and the **scholar** later presented them at the conference.

_____

2. The committee debated the **advantages** of the policy as well as its **disadvantages**.

_____

3. The **keyboard** and **screen** are essential components of a laptop.

_____

4. The **rose**, **tulip**, and **orchid** were arranged beautifully in the garden.

_____

5. The professor's **lecture** was followed by a brief **talk** addressing students' questions.

_____

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Question 3:

Each of the following clauses has different types of grammatical cohesion indicated by the underlined words/phrases in **bold**. Write the type of grammatical cohesion for each as: ***text connector, anaphoric reference, cataphoric reference, noun substitution, verb substitution, clause substitution, or ellipsis.*** ***(5 marks: 1 mark each)***

1. The first team completed the project successfully; the second **did** as well.

_____

2. **Although** the methodology was complex, the students managed to understand it.

_____

3. When the experiment concluded, **it** produced unexpected findings.

_____

4. The initial hypothesis seemed convincing, but the revised **one** proved more accurate.

_____

5. **This** is what the lecturer emphasized: critical thinking is essential in academic research.

_____

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Question 4:

Underline the theme(s) in the following clauses and identify each as **marked or unmarked**.

(5 marks: underlining theme(s) = 0.5 mark and labelling the theme(s) = 0.5)

1. Across many disciplines, critical thinking is considered an essential skill.

_____

2. The participants in the survey reported positive attitudes toward online learning.

_____

3. By applying innovative teaching strategies, educators can improve student engagement.

_____

4. The findings of the report highlight the need for sustainable development policies.

_____

5. In several developing countries, access to higher education remains limited.

_____

FOU EGYPT

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PART B
Two Writing Questions
Answer ONLY ONE (10 marks)

Question 1:

Write an extended definition paragraph for FOUR of the following terms (70-100 words) in which you define, explain, and discuss the following grammatical terms and concepts clearly and fully as they are discussed in the relevant course unit materials. Support your answers with relevant examples to illustrate your understanding, using your own words. ***(10 marks)***

1. Interactivity ***(2.5 marks)***
2. Nominalization ***(2.5 marks)***
3. Lexical bundle ***(2.5 marks)***
4. Co- hyponymy ***(2.5 marks)***
5. Cohesion ***(2.5 marks)***

Question 2:

Write an essay (300–350 words) in which you explain and discuss **lexical cohesion (lexical chains)** as a resource that helps make the text below **coherent and unified**. *(10 marks)*

Your essay should address the following questions:

- **What is lexical cohesion?** *(2 marks)*
- **What are its main types?** *(4 marks)*
- **Why do writers use lexical cohesion?** *(2 marks)*
- **How can lexical cohesion be used effectively in writing?** *(2 marks)*

Your answer must be **clear, focused, and well organized**. Illustrate your explanation with **examples from the text**. Use **your own words**.

The Impact of Social Media on Communication

Social media has significantly transformed the way people communicate in modern society. Platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter allow individuals to share ideas, opinions, and personal experiences with a global audience. These digital spaces enable instant interaction, making communication faster and more accessible than ever before.

At the same time, social media has influenced the nature of interpersonal relationships. Many users rely on online messages, comments, and reactions to maintain connections with friends an family. While these tools help people stay in touch, some researchers argue that online interaction may reduce the depth of face-to-face communication.

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Another important aspect of social media is its influence on information sharing. News stories, videos, and articles can spread rapidly through online networks. As a result, social media platforms have become powerful channels for both information and misinformation.

Despite these challenges, social media continues to shape communication practices worldwide. Educators, businesses, and governments increasingly use these platforms to reach audiences, promote ideas, and encourage public engagement. Consequently, understanding the linguistic and social dynamics of social media communication has become an important area of research.

PROTOCOL

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